

here are so many amazing companies out there, but so few of them are in a position where their level of execution is what will decide their fate.

It's rare to get a combination of the right market, product, people, and culture all at the right time · GitLab has that, and that's why I'm here.

About Me

I'm a builder and a grinder by nature. I've found that channeling my energy into building and mobilizing teams, solving challenging problems, and delivering business outcomes produces an outsized return in a variety of areas, both personal and professional. This has translated into a true love of work for me.

I tend to move fast, think long-term, and care deeply about outcomes. I believe that business, at its core, is mobilizing people. And mobilizing people requires the right combination of inspiration, motivation, and prescription.

I work best when the goal is clear, and the pace is high; I am energized by solving problems with smart people and turning ideas into action.

You'll find that I lead with an open door, a low ego, and a bias toward action. I speak with conviction but welcome pushback.

My goal is to create an environment where great ideas rise, people grow, and results follow.

My Values

1. Growth - I'm always learning and value working with people open to new perspectives, feedback, and challenges. Growth comes from curiosity, not just effort.

1. Integrity - I do what's right for the business, provided it doesn't compromise my core principles. Integrity builds trust, and trust enables performance. When you take a long-term view and focus on what's right for the business, benefit tends to naturally accrue to you over time.

1. Performance - In the areas where I choose to invest my time and compete, I do it with the goal of performing at the highest level possible and winning.

My Superpowers

1. Action · I'm maniacally focused on execution. Those who work closely with me will often hear me ask:

- > "But did the field adopt it?"
- > "Is it actually improving productivity?"
- > "What specific actions will come out of that meeting that impact the business tomorrow?"
- > "Does the team know HOW to do that?"

I inherently believe that businesses overindex on strategy and underindex on execution · and the ability to execute creates a massive competitive advantage!

2. Boldness · I think and dream big · and believe truly audacious goals can be accomplished. The ability to do something starts with the belief that it can be done.

3. Grit · I've learned that I'm very resilient, and most people are more resilient than they may actually believe. If you can learn to find comfort in discomfort, you'll continue to make progress even in the face of major challenges.

My Weaknesses

1. Directness · I move quickly to business substance, and can overlook people's feelings or nuances that are important to others. I'm always working on this, and open to being called on it.

1. Impatience · My general bias towards action sometimes manifests in impatience and some level of annoyance with the status quo. I'm constantly trying to find the right balance of acting with intention and continually improving with having realistic expectations of what can be done in a specified time period.

1. Balance · Finding the right work-life balance while keeping a demanding pace has been a growth area for me. What's really helped is building a system · my Saturdays have become incredibly productive blocks where I dive deep into data, strategize, and clear my inbox. Importantly, this also means setting clear boundaries for my team; I expect them to handle things during work hours so they can properly switch off outside of that, unless it's truly urgent. This approach lets me run at the speed I need to while still protecting my teams' personal time.

Communication Style

1. Bottom-line first · Lead with the decision or recommendation, then provide context and data.

1. Async preferred · Slack or email with a clear headline, context, and ask. For transactional items, I'll usually address them on the same day, items that require more thought but are not urgent, the same week, often on Saturday or Sunday mornings, but I don't expect a response back over the weekend.

1. Quick calls for nuance · Strategic and complex topics are better live. Call my cell, send me a text, or work with my EBA, and we'll prioritize accordingly.

1. Open to challenge · I think out loud and revise quickly. Don't confuse my decisiveness with finality; I'm open to being challenged.

My Expectations of the Team

1. Adaptability · We're in a dynamic growth-oriented environment, and while we should not waste energy on low-yield pursuits or changes, we need to be in a state of continual improvement and not settling for the status quo. I expect my team to be adaptable and receptive to change that will positively impact the business.

1. Meritocratic and apolitical · I believe that excessive corporate politics are a result of a broken values system. Rewarding individuals for something other than effort or performance

breeds politics and a focus on things that will not positively impact the business. We will partner to create a meritocratic environment that rewards results and reduces politics.

1. Focus on impact · Showing people ·how· is leadership. If we are unable to articulate how to do something, our strategy is incomplete and will likely not have its desired impact. We should constantly be asking ourselves whether we know ·how· to do something, and if the answer is ·no·, we need to surface and change.

1. Solution orientation · Warren Buffet famously said: ·Predicting rain doesn't count; building arks does.· I couldn't agree more. Our ability to, and the speed at which we, pivot from identifying problems to solving them will have a material impact on business outcomes.

My Role

I am the Chief Revenue Officer of GitLab.

I'm responsible for driving growth through alignment, accountability, and operational excellence across all revenue functions.

My job is to ensure we execute at pace, with clarity, and in service of the company and customers' long-term success.

Final Note

High-performing teams are built on trust, accountability, and a shared commitment to results. My goal is to create the conditions for that to happen at scale. If we stay aligned and move with intent, we'll build something meaningful and lasting.

Let's get to work!

SECTION: sales/readmes/noah-ing.md

<!-- This template will help you build out your very own GitLab README, a great tool for transparently letting others know what it's like to work with you, and how you prefer to be communicated with. Each section is optional. You can remove those you aren't comfortable filling out, and add sections that are germane to you. -->

Noah Ing's README

Solutions Architect, Americas (Mid Market)

Related pages

<!-- Add links to relevant pages that add context to who you are. Examples include blog posts, social media profiles, portfolios, reels, personal homepages, etc. -->

- LinkedIn

- GitLab

- My Contributions: GitLab Product Issues | GitLab Product Merge Requests | GitLab Marketing Merge Requests

About me

<!--

[Consider embedding a video of you working or being interviewed, along with 5-10 bullet points outlining interesting tidbits about you and your interests. Focus these on non-work attributes. Also, add detail on what GitLab values and sub-values resonate most with you. This enables ice-breakers to occur ahead of meetings.]

-->

- It has been a career-long goal for me to work at GitLab ever since using GitLab for the first time
- Prior to working at GitLab I worked as a DevOps engineer for 5 years mainly focusing on Cloud Infrastructure using AWS and GCP
- This is my first experience being officially part of a sales team, and I love it. I feel it compliments my deep interest in performance arts
- I have a passionate interest in Hip Hop, Jazz and Funk music. Khruangbin is my favourite band
- I am born and raised in Toronto, Canada.

My working style

<!-- Add 5-10 bullets on how you prefer to work, interact with others, and learn. You may optionally include intel from Strength Deployment Inventory, Myers-Briggs, etc. This is most effective when you are precise and specific about your norms, assumptions, and expectations. If you are unsure what would be helpful here, ask your colleagues for their input. You may learn something from listening to outside perspective! -->

- I bias towards action. I'm happy to iterate and learn the hard way
- I am a visual learner and enjoy visual cues to get the point across
- I take notes on every meeting I have. I'm very prone to forgetting so this is how I keep up
- I like having an agenda for my meetings sprinkled with light banter and jokes
- I am a stickler for systems and processes. I develop good habits and routines for even the most straight forward task.

What I assume about others

<!-- Add 5-10 bullets on the assumptions you typically hold when working with others. Strive to be as open with these as possible, so others understand your perspective when engaging with you on projects. Remember, the honesty put forth in these answers enables others to be more understanding and empathetic. -->

- I assume others to have a sense of humour and laugh atleast once in a while
- I assume positive intent at all times. If something comes across negatively, I typically clarify with them
- I assume others will communicate what they are thinking transparently
- I assume that everyone does their due dilligence before meeting
- I assume everyone is respectful of each others time during business hours

Communicating with me

<!-- Consider 5-10 bullets on your communication preferences. This includes traditional styles

such as verbal, textual, and visual, but you are encouraged to be precise. You can mention things like routine, availability, your travel habits, etc. This helps others understand why you communicate in the manner than you do, and it enables them to tailor their communication in a way that resonates most with you.

-->

I will always do my best to provide same-day responses to customer inquiries and follow-ups unless otherwise noted. Here are the mediums I am most responsive (in order of responsiveness):

1. Slack
1. Email
1. GitLab Issues (ones in which I am mentioned via @noah.ing)
1. Mentions in Google Docs/Sheets/etc.

Again, expect a same-day response and don't hesitate to try a different medium if my response time is poor.

Strengths/Weaknesses

<!-- These may be covered in the above sections. If you prefer a section devoted to strengths and weaknesses, this will enable others to lean on your areas of published expertise and offer support in weak areas without passing judgment. -->

Strengths:

- Resilient
- Team Player
- Good Listener
- Optimistic
- Adapt Quickly

Weaknesses:

- Lacking attention to detail
- Bad at multi-tasking
- Overly idealistic

SECTION: sales/readmes/tim-poffenbarger.md

<!-- This template will help you build out your very own GitLab README, a great tool for transparently letting others know what it's like to work with you, and how you prefer to be communicated with. Each section is optional. You can remove those you aren't comfortable filling out, and add sections that are germane to you. -->

Tim Poffenbarger's README

Senior Manager, Solutions Architects - Commercial

Related pages

<!-- Add links to relevant pages that add context to who you are. Examples include blog posts, social media profiles, portfolios, reels, personal homepages, etc. -->

- LinkedIn
- GitLab
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About me

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-->

How you can help me

<!-- Add 5-10 bullet points on what others can do to make your life easier when working with you. Strive to include elements that are nonobvious, or that people would not typically think to ask or consult you about. This enables others to be more efficient in helping you in a way that feels like help. -->

In the Solutions Architect role, the more our team can get an opportunity to focus on communicating value and stay away from very deep technical and troubleshooting conversations, the more the team can help you achieve target sales. The team is happy to review and contribute to business plans so we remain in sync.

The team is happy to recommend and propose services for prospects and customers. For any custom statement of work, the team can begin scoping out the initial scope of work (SOW) and get approvals from the Professional Services team.

My working style

<!-- Add 5-10 bullets on how you prefer to work, interact with others, and learn. You may optionally include intel from Strength Deployment Inventory, Myers-Briggs, etc. This is most effective when you are precise and specific about your norms, assumptions, and expectations. If you are unsure what would be helpful here, ask your colleagues for their input. You may learn something from listening to outside perspective! -->

Response time for emails and meeting follow-ups: I will always do my best to provide same-day responses to customer inquiries and follow-ups unless otherwise noted. I like to provide customers top-notch service, but interruptions can impact that target. I will use my out-of-office when traveling so customers can expect delayed responses during those times. Feel free to contact me if it's approaching the end of the day and you didn't see me address a customer request. Slack is the easiest way to find me most of the time.

Calendar: Schedule things as necessary right on my calendar during working hours · I'll do my

best to keep my calendar up to date. However, if you see only one empty slot for a day or if it looks like the meeting would be back to back with something else, please check with me before confirming dates and times with the customer. If you want me at my best for you, I will need time to prepare and follow-up. If we schedule back to back, I've found I'm often late to arrive due to the last meeting, flustered as I context shift, lacking answers for known questions, unprepared with demo environments that were altered in the last call, etc.

Synchronous Communication for Ongoing Efforts: If I have an ongoing effort with individuals, they should feel encouraged to setup weekly strategy 25-minute calls with me and others involved. If more frequent synchronous communication is desirable or required, we should work together as a team to identify a viable cadence, required attendees, convenient time and agenda for those calls.

Where Information is Stored: You can assume that all information is kept in the Customers & Prospects folder in Google Drive under the appropriately designated letter. This folder will be linked in Salesforce. Email communication with customers will also be bcc'd to Salesforce. If you prefer to record notes and actions differently, please let me know what that collaborative method is.

Continuous Learning: Things at GitLab move really fast, and I need time to keep up. I'll block a few hours on my calendar coincident with releases to absorb the latest GitLab feature set, but new technologies and competitive products also appear regularly. Please expect that I will need to allocate additional time to learning about those on a regular basis to sufficiently support our customers.

What I assume about others

<!-- Add 5-10 bullets on the assumptions you typically hold when working with others. Strive to be as open with these as possible, so others understand your perspective when engaging with you on projects. Remember, the honesty put forth in these answers enables others to be more understanding and empathetic. -->

I assume that if there is anything you are expecting from me to do, it is clearly stated and written down somewhere that we both can access. Unless it is at the genesis of a particular ask, it is best to ensure that you and I agree that this is my task before others are engaged in our conversation.

What I want to earn

<!--Consider 3-5 bullets on your goals for earning things like trust and respect, or a broader understanding of new topics. This enables others to understand what motivates you. -->

- Your trust - specifically so that positive intent is assumed by default

Communicating with me

<!-- Consider 5-10 bullets on your communication preferences. This includes traditional styles such as verbal, textual, and visual, but you are encouraged to be precise. You can mention things like routine, availability, your travel habits, etc. This helps others understand why you communicate in the manner than you do, and it enables them to tailor their communication in

a way that resonates most with you.

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1. Email
1. GitLab Issues (ones in which I am mentioned via @poffey21)
1. Mentions in Google Docs/Sheets/etc.

Again, expect a same-day response and don't hesitate to try a different medium if my response time is poor.

Strengths/Weaknesses

<!-- These may be covered in the above sections. If you prefer a section devoted to strengths and weaknesses, this will enable others to lean on your areas of published expertise and offer support in weak areas without passing judgment. -->

Strengths: I am technically proficient and can come up to speed on a technical topic quickly. I feel that I provide most value to customers that are engineering software. Although, I can speak to the needs of folks that are across all stages of the Software Development Life Cycle.

Weaknesses: I can get consumed with building out a technical solution and let other priorities slip. If you feel that I'm letting priorities slip that are important to you and the organization, do not hesitate to call me out.

SECTION: sales/sales-google-groups/_index.md

This page is meant to serve as a guide to communicating with and within the Field using both Slack and email. Read below to find an outline of all Google Groups and Slack channels related to Sales and Customer Success.

In order to drive clarity on this page, it is important to note the difference in definitions between:

1. Sales: Refers to team members in the Enterprise and Commercial Sales teams.
1. CS: Refers to team members in the groups that make up the Customer Success organization.
1. Field: Refers to ALL members of the GTM team · Sales, CS, Marketing (SDRs), Professional Services.

Google Groups

The parent google group of the sales team is sales-all. Several child groups fall within the parent group.

| Group Name | Group Level/Access | Description |

| ----- | ----- | ----- |

| sales-all | organization | Includes all members of the sales and CS teams as well as stakeholders across the business |

| sales-leaders | leadership | Regional directors and above (ASM and above for COM) |

| cs-leaders | leadership | VP Customer Success direct reports |

| field-managers | leadership | ASMs and above or equivalents on the CS/Channel/Alliance/SDR side who are people managers |

| sales-ent-managers | leadership | ASMs and above on the Enterprise team |

| sales-com-managers | leadership | ASMs and above on the Commercial team |

| sales-cs-managers | leadership | Managers and above on the Customer Success team |

| sales-commercial | segment | Members of the commercial sales team |

| sales-ent | segment | Members of the enterprise sales team |

| sales-emea | team | Members of the ENT EMEA sales team |

| sales-apac | team | Members of the ENT APAC sales team |

| sales-east | team | Members of the ENT AMER east sales team |

| sales-west | team | Members of the ENT AMER west sales team |

| sales-pubsec | team | Members of the ENT pubsec sales team |

| sales-cs | segment | Members of the customer success team |

| partnersallhands | segment | Members of the Partner team |

| rsoe-team | segment | Members of the Revenue Strategy, Operations and Enablement (RSOE) team |

| sales-ops | team | Members of the sales operations team |

| field-enablement | team | Members of the field enablement team |

To confirm if you are in a particular Google Group, see the Google Workspace Group Membership Reports. To gain access to new Google Groups, please fill out an access request (AR) form.

Slack Channels and Groups

The primary Slack channels for the field are:

- field-fyi: Official field announcements channel. Restricted permission levels to help streamline important updates. (Find more information [here](#).)
- sales: The general channel for WW Sales open to posts from all team members.
- sales-support: The general channel to ask for sales support from Field Operations.
- customer-success: The general channel to interact with & within Customer Success.

All field team members should star · and follow these four channels for important updates about the business. There are multiple team channels in the field organization, outlined below. Please follow the channels relevant to your role. To gain access to private channels, please fill out an access request (AR) form.

Slack Groups

Slack Groups are groups of members in a workspace who often need to be notified at once. The Field organization has multiple Slack Groups that effectively allow a group of people to be cc'd on a Slack communication. Please note that Slack groups send a push notification to all members and should be used sparingly, in accordance with the guidelines around @here mentions in the Handbook.

Only use Slack Groups if:

1. The content of the message is hyper-relevant to ALL members of the group
1. The content of the message is time-sensitive and/or needs immediate action
1. The content of the message has significant impact to the business and/or team

Group Name	Group Members/Description
salesleaders	Regional directors and above (ASM and above for COM)
csleaders	VP Customer Success direct reports
fieldmanagers	ASMs and above or equivalents on the CS/Channel/Alliance/SDR side who are people managers
salesentmanagers	ASMs and above on the Enterprise team
salescommanagers	ASMs and above on the Commercial team
salescsmanagers	Managers and above on the Customer Success team

Field Slack Channels

The below channels are specific to the field organization.

Organization-Wide/Management

Channel Name	Channel Access (Private/Public)	Description
sales	public	General channel for WW Sales, open to posts from all team members
field-fyi	public (read-only)	Official field announcements channel
cro	public	CRO (Chief Revenue Officer) announcements and communication
sales-vp	public	Used for scheduling requests, etc. related to all field VPs
field-managers	private	Confidential (people and/or comp-related) communication with Field (Sales, CS, SDR) managers - ASMs or equivalent and above

Sales

Channel Name	Channel Access (Private/Public)	Description
apacfieldteam	public	Team channel for APAC sales team
eastsales	public	Team channel for ENT U.S. East sales team
westsales	public	Team channel for ENT U.S. West sales team
mid-atlantic-sales	public	Team channel for ENT U.S. Mid Atlantic sales team
emea-sals	public	Team channel for ENT EMEA sales team
public-sector-sales	private	Team channel for Public Sector sales team
emeamid-marketsales	public	Team channel for EMEA Mid-Market sales team
commercialglobalall	private	Team channel for global Commercial sales team

Customer Success

Consistent with company guidance to use public channels, there are instances where private channels are preferred. As we want to ensure an inclusive environment, the feedback from some of the team is that private channels are sometimes preferred as there is a perception of being judged (i.e., imposter syndrome). The recommendation is to use public channels as it:

- Allows for broader collaboration (i.e., SA/CSM/PS, Product, Marketing, Sales) on solutions, recommendations, and best practices
- Provides ability for broader learning for things such as customer challenges, enablement needs, product documentation improvements, etc.
- Enables the ability to harvest the information for content (i.e., CSM solutions, adoption content for digital journey, product documentation)

The recommendation is to use public channels even while it may sometimes feel uncomfortable as we want to embrace this.

Channel Name	Channel Access (Private/Public)	Description
customer-success	public	Used to interact with & within Customer Success
cs-questions	public	Questions from customers and prospects to the Customer Success team about using GitLab and best practices
demo-systems	public	Open discussion and questions about demo systems that aren't appropriate for issues
professional-services	public	Used to communicate with the Professional Services team

Field Operations

Channel Name	Channel Access (Private/Public)	Description
sales-support	public	Support for general sales-related questions, requests, and updates
field-enablement-team	public	Used for communication between GitLab sales and CS team members and the field enablement team

Channels and Alliances

Channel Name	Channel Access (Private/Public)	Description
cloud-aws or cloud-gcp	public	Questions regarding alliance partners
channel-sales	public	Topics related to channel sales
partner-programs-ops	public	Topics related to partner programs and operations
channel-marketing	public	Topics related to channel marketing
channel-services	public	Topics related to channel services
channel-accred-mvp	public	Communication about the channel partner accreditation program

Helpful Company Slack Channels

The below channels are owned by teams outside of the field organization but might be helpful for field team members to follow given the nature of their roles.

Channel Name	Channel Access (Private/Public)	Description
company-fyi	public (read-only)	Official company announcements channel
company-fyi-private	private (read-only)	Official & confidential company announcements channel
whats-happening-at-gitlab	public	Team-wide communication and announcements (reminders, events, project updates, etc.)
ceo	public	Questions and requests for the CEO

competition	public	Used to share competitive insight/information from the market in real time and to ask the competitive intelligence team questions about how they might handle certain situations
supportops-announcements	public (read-only)	Sharing updates on Support-related changes
legal	public	General legal questions that are not confidential or seeking legal advice
marketing	public	General marketing team channel
sdr-global	public	Used to ask questions and provide useful information related to XDRs
salesdevfyi	public (read-only)	The official SDR announcements channel
content-updates	public	The latest GitLab-published content you can share with prospects on social media
newswire	public	News mentions and industry news related to GitLab
diversityinclusionandbelonging	public	Get updates and receive feedback on all things related to Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging
eba-team	public	Communicate with the EA team; schedule time with the CEO and CRO

SECTION: sales/sales-google-groups/field-fyi-channel.md

The field-fyi channel is the official field announcements channel. This is a read-only channel with permission levels restricted to Field and Company Leadership as well as Field Operations. The purpose of this channel is to pull news and announcements out of sales, where they can easily get buried, and consolidate them in a streamlined channel. Anyone is free to react to and comment on posts in this channel, and field team members are encouraged to star it to stay up-to-date. For general field channels, see sales and customer-success.

Best Practices

1. Even though the read only channel will help cut down on noise, we still aim to post no more than 3 updates in one day to avoid saturating the team. (Some days we will have nothing to post, which is a plus!)

1. If we've already hit the 3 post limit, please consider if your update can wait until the following business day before posting.

1. Feedback from the team already stresses that there is too much reading/block text. Slack should be a reprieve from this. We should aim to keep Slack updates as short and consumable as possible · 100 words or shorter as a best practice.

1. Use numbered lists when possible to summarize key points.

1. Link out to relevant documentation for any points that need additional context. Hit on the highlights in the update and let the documentation take it from there.

1. Avoid having multiple link previews accompanying a post. Only keep the ones that are valuable to getting the point across. Delete all others. (Deleting all is okay, too.)

1. ALL field-fyi messages should contain a header in the approved format. Please see field-FYI Post Headers section below for more details.

1. A peripheral goal of the field-fyi channel is to cut down on noise in other channels like sales and customer-success to make them more easily consumable. As a result, this channel should be the single source of Slack truth for important field announcements. Avoid cross posting to other channels when possible, as this will create more noise and defeat the purpose of the channel.

field-fyi Post Headers

Based on team member feedback, each field-fyi post has a bolded header that helps team members quickly identify the audience, topic and level of urgency/type of action. The header follows this format: AUDIENCE] | [TOPIC] | [TYPE] | [URGENCY]. You can find instructions on what to include in this header and how to format it in the [Field announcement request issue template when requesting an announcement.

1. Audience

- All Field (Sales, CS, Channel & Alliances, Ops)
- All Sales (ENT & COMM)
- ENT Sales
- COMM Sales
- Customer Success
- Channel Team
- Alliances Team
- Field Operations

1. Topic

- Operations
- Enablement
- Competitive Intelligence
- Customer Reference
- Product Marketing
- Marketing
- Product
- Pricing & Packaging

1. Type

- New mandatory enablement
- New optional enablement
- System Changes/System Updates
- Bookings Update
- New Resource
- Survey
- Process Change
- Roadmap Update
- Org Announcement

1. Urgency

- · Action Required - urgent, action required with a due date
 - Example: Mandatory enablement launch
- · Need to Know - urgent, update directly impacts audiences' workflows/processes
 - Example: Sales Ops process change
- · Feedback Requested - less urgent, action requested (with or without long-lead due date)

but not required

- Example: Survey from Product org
- · Review - less urgent, does not directly or materially impact audiences' workflows/processes
 - Example: New customer story or new competitive resource

Q&A

What are some examples of a post fit for sales vs field-fyi?

1. Examples of sales posts: General team questions, reminders about meetings, general chatter from team members, non time-sensitive updates/resources.

1. Examples of field-fyi posts: Updates from CRO, noteworthy process changes, important and time-sensitive resources, (enablement, sales ops, marketing etc.) time-sensitive People Ops information.

What is the difference between field-fyi and cro channels?

1. The cro channel is for announcements and communication specifically from/to the CRO about business-related topics. Examples include recognition, observations, CRO calls-to-action.

1. In some rare cases, process-related updates that come from the CRO will be posted to field-fyi.

1. Alluding again to the format that we've taken with company-fyi - the CEO still has their ceo channel that they use to communicate with the team/field questions, but organization-wide posts go on company-fyi.

Do I have to run my field-fyi post by Field Communications?

1. Yes! Field Comms' primary responsibility is to ensure that the Field team gets their information in the most effective and efficient way. They are here as a resource for you to help you get the largest reach possible out of your announcement by collaborating with you on the best timing and a multi-channel communication plan.

If someone has an update fitting for field-fyi but doesn't have posting permissions, how can they get their news shared?

1. If it's a one-off request, please reach out to field-enablement-team or create a brief issue summarizing your requested announcement using the Field announcements request process.

1. If a team member needs the ability to share updates on a recurring basis, they can work directly with the Field Enablement team to discuss posting permissions.

SECTION: sales/sales-operating-procedures/_index.md

This documentation is based on the GitLab Sales Process document approved in February 2020.

1. Engage and Educate the Customer

1. Facilitate the Opportunity

1. Deal Closure

1. Retain and Expand

How to Use

The intention of SOPs is to make our sales processes clear and document them in detail in a single place. These SOPs will also serve as the pillars for the Field Certification Program.

SOPs are not meant to solve for every permutation of selling scenarios that you might face.

There will be times that the processes outlined in the SOPs do not apply or need to be expanded upon/deviated from. In this case, we encourage you to feel empowered to do what is necessary to

support your customer and your business.

Please reach out to your manager or the Field Enablement team (Slack: field-enablement-team) with any questions.

For more information on each SOP phase, see the recordings from our four-part webinar series:

Date	SOP Phase
2020-05-15	Phase 1: Educate and Engage the Customer
2020-05-29	Phase 2: Facilitate the Opportunity
2020-06-11	Phase 3: Deal Closure
2020-07-09	Phase 4: Retain and Expand

SECTION: sales/sales-operating-procedures/deal-closure.md

You have obtained the verbal commit from the economic buyer and it's now time to close the opportunity and get the deal signature. You will need to reapply MEDDPIC throughout this phase to accomplish the following tasks and close the deal:

1. Create a Mutual Close Plan
1. Create a Deal Package
1. Conduct Negotiations
1. Create a Final Quote
1. Acquire Signature

1. Create a Mutual Close Plan

A mutual close plan is a visual timeline of all the necessary tasks, individuals, and deadlines necessary to get the deal through closure and into deployment. A mutual close plan must have mutual outcome. It is created with your champions, advocates, and economic buyers. It will highlight gaps on both sides of the table so that they can be addressed and advance the deal to closure and deployment. Additionally, it allows you to coordinate/facilitate closure of the deal through your guidance of the process. Here is a example/template you can download to complete with your champion, economic buyer, SA, and CSM.

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1.1 Rediscovery

Rediscovery involves additional engagements to capture and re-verify the business drivers of

the opportunity. You will use deeper open-ended questions to gather the following information:

1. Redocument Business Drivers

1. Paper Process - Increase your knowledge of the customer's procurement/vendor management process. You will need to understand if they have been through the purchase process before or not.

- Use open-ended questions to determine if they have been through procurement before
- Use multiple choice questions if they have not

1. Capture pricing information - This requires additional discovery and analysis to capture the following information:

- Is the purchase a budgeted line item or discretionary spending?
- How much are they allowed to spend?
- What is the time horizon for this initiative to be implemented?
- What are the logistical needs for project deployment
- How fast do they need to move on this project?

2. Create a Deal Package

A deal package is an additional component of the customer deck you used earlier. The deal package must include everything the customer needs for a complete solution for long term use while also taking into account budget information you captured earlier. The deal package within the customer deck should include the following components:

- Business Case Proposal
- Mutual Close Plan
- Master Software Agreement
- Preliminary Pricing Proposal by tier based on the POV developed by the SA
- Execution and Tracking of Mutual Close Plan

3. Negotiations

Rule to Remember: You should only discount when real budget constraints are the hold up to the purchase.

Negotiations are defined as a discussion aimed at reaching a mutually beneficial agreement. At this point in deal closure, the economic buyer has received the deal package. You have conducted a number of engagements with the economic buyer, the technical champion, and advocates to create a package that provides a definitive solution to their business problems while also being priced in the appropriate product tier necessary for the customer to be successful. Yet, they want a discount.

Rule to Remember: If they push back, you probably missed something during your discovery process.

When this happens..you need to conduct additional discovery to work around the customer push back.

3.1 Ask Why?

1. Find out why they suddenly want to negotiate even though they were included in the deal

proposal at all phases. Ask why? - Understand why they are asking for something. Confirm in the customer's words that they see the value of GitLab. Determine what has changed and why the business goal you solved for may no longer be their priority. Remind them of why they are here.

1. Determine if they are asking because they are trained to ask for concessions or if it truly is a money issue.

1. Understand who you're negotiating with because if it's a Procurement or Purchasing department instead of the economic buyer, remember that 70% of the time Procurement always asks for discounts with no understanding of the solution. Procurement's job is to get as low a price as possible. In these instances, work with your champion to get a feel for the pricing based on justification and ROI. Also, test your champion again on the decision/paper process to get through the hurdles of pricing. Engage with Champion and Vendor Management POCs..who can cut business up..Need champions to help remove business level barriers.. Finding money, vendor barriers.

1. Barter.. What are we getting in return? If GitLab doesn't approve a discount, what will happen? Ask the customer what the risk is of not doing this? The client has to make judgment on the risk. Negotiations should rarely go beyond the discount matrix because of the work done to align the business requirements with GitLab capabilities and service tiers. You can guide the customer to start smaller on a lower tier and/or with fewer users and expand usage over a longer period of time (generally 3 years plus). Utilize the following Deal Approval Matrix to understand your flexibility when negotiating.

Additionally, during the negotiation phase you should also be working with the Customer Success Team to plan a smooth transition for the customer. Below are the three tasks/deliverables that need to be captured and executed prior to closing the deal.

3.2 Customer Success Planning

3.2.1 Capture Customer Success Criteria

The Solution Architect (SA) Documents Success Criteria This can be accomplished by facilitating a discovery workshop asking questions about what a successful rollout plan looks like, the expectations around user experience during a transition period, and how to educate the customer's end-users. This process will help clarify whether positioning professional services is appropriate at this stage during the customer buying journey.

This activity should produce a document that clearly articulates what done looks like and when done is successful. The document should be signed by an accountable individual from both parties and verbally discussed.

3.2.2 Create Customer Success Plan

The SA and CSM work with the customer to create a Customer Success Plan. A Success Plan is an interactive map to align the purchase (including renewals!) reasons to customer outcomes, develop joint accountabilities, measure progress and evolve as customers' needs change. Put another way, it's the way the customer can see and know that they're obtaining significantly more value than the cost of a product or service. Click on the link above to follow the steps to create a Customer Success Plan.

4. Final Quote Creation

Once negotiations are concluded and a final price point per user and terms are established, a final quote and Master Service Agreement (MSA) needs to be created to submit for signature.

- Quote
- Master Service Agreement (MSA)

This step can be looked at as an extension of the negotiation process and the time horizon for final quote approval, and MSA review can vary greatly between the Commercial Sales and Enterprise Sales based on the customer's purchasing processes.

4.1 Create a New Quote

A quote is created in Salesforce. Create a New Quote. Generally once you submit a quote it will be sent to the customer's legal team to redline and review.

EMEA specific Quote Creation Considerations:

1. EU based companies must have a VAT reference number.
2. EMEA must always ask the new or existing customer for the VAT reference number and re-enter it into the quote
3. The company's correct legal entity name must be manually entered into the quote versus the automated or assumed name that may auto-populate.

4.2 Master Service Agreement

A Master Service Agreement (or MSA) is a contract reached between parties in which the parties agree to most of the terms that will govern future transactions or future agreements. Generally, Sales works with Legal to redline the document with the customer's legal representation. Once the redlining is completed, the deal is then ready to move to signature.

5. SIGNATURE

The final stage is signature. By this time the due diligence, negotiations, and revisions have been done and it's now time to have the deal signed by the economic buyer. The following components are submitted as a package:

- Customer Deck with Mutual Close Plan
- Clean Quote
- Clean version of the MSA

6. Next Steps

1. Update the opportunity in Salesforce as Closed/Won or Lost
2. AE/SAE coordinates a Welcome Call to introduce the CSM to the customer stakeholders.

Congratulations! You are now ready to move the deal to the Retain and Expand phase.

SECTION: sales/sales-operating-procedures/facilitate-the-opportunity.md

You have qualified a lead and now you need to turn it into a sale. This phase is called Facilitate the Opportunity. The goal of this phase is to achieve a technical commit followed by an economic commit from the customer. A Commit is a verbal acknowledgement from the buyer that they want to proceed with the deal. In this phase there are 4 high level tasks you need to complete to get a technical and economic commit:

- Discovery
- Scoping
- Technical Evaluation/Technical Commit from a Technical Buyer
- Economic Commit from an Economic Buyer

Again the four tasks above are demonstrable outputs of correctly applying MEDDPIC and Command of the Message (CoM) within each of the tasks. This also supports your transition from appearing as a common software sales person into a trusted consultant that brings business solutions instead of multiple invoices and a smile.

Step 1: Discovery Questioning

Traditional sales typically bypasses understanding the customer. Traditional sales relies heavily on getting a foot in the door with a customer by overwhelming them with product information in the hopes that a buzz word or some random product feature will catch the customer's attention and build urgency in the customer. GitLab doesn't operate that way. GitLab uses Discovery Questioning.

Discovery Questions help to uncover existing customer needs, problems, pain points, goals etc. Regardless of the opportunity being handed off from an SDR or qualified by you, you should always create discovery questions based on the following research process and criteria.

1.1 Research

1.1.1 Determine your Buyer Persona

A buyer persona is a fictional representation of your key buyers. This helps you pre-identify obstacles, objections, initiatives, and metrics that are important to your buyer. This step will give you an edge in understanding your customers better than your competition. There are typically 5 buyer personas you may encounter.

- Technology Leader
- Business Application Leader
- Security Leaders
- CXO Leader
- Financial Leader

1.1.2 Reference Buyer Process Maps

Buyer Process Maps (BPMs) highlight and explain the mental pathways buyers' travel to make decisions and help to guide selling activity based on where the buyer is in their process. Your goals in this step include differentiation, reduction in resistance, avoid wasting cycles, and facilitating better meetings and creating. See a breakdown of the Buyer Process Map and the common buyer actions

that indicate what stages of the buyer process the prospect is in.

1.1.3 Research the buyer

This step includes a number of sub-tasks necessary to obtain additional buyer insights:

1. Reference SFDC to see if the lead is a current customer or prospect. Review their digital body language such as recent activities and past contact.
1. Reference LinkedIn and cross reference the contact's profile to relevant buyer personas and look for overlaps.
1. Reference the company's website and absorb basics related to strategic goals, industry, business model, their buyer, etc.

1.1.4 Create discovery questions

Leverage MEDDPIC to gather the information necessary to qualify the opportunity.

- Discovery Questions are designed to identify existing customer needs, problems, pain points, goals etc.
- MEDDPIC is a qualification framework that will help you determine if the opportunity is worth your time, effort, and company resources. This is an aspect of Pre-Call Planning. The pre-call planning questions will cause you as the seller to further validate and reference the buyer persona you will engage with. It will help you to more quickly determine what stage the buyer falls in the sales process. The framework will also expose problems and clarify next steps. It will help make you more efficient and focused sales representatives by making it easier to sort the good deals from no deals, and quick deals from long term deals.

1.1.5 Develop a persona-based call plan

This step helps to ensure you gather more pertinent information from the buyer. More specifically, it will help you identify information gaps, set specific objectives, and ultimately increase your buyer's confidence in you. Use the two job aids below to prepare for your discovery calls.

- Use Sales Discovery and Qualification Questions to create questions that are tailored to the specific buyer persona with whom you'll be engaging.
- Use the Customer Requirements Document to list all of your questions as part of your discovery call meeting preparation.

1.1.6 Conduct discovery call meetings

Discovery doesn't take place in just one call. It takes place over a series of meetings. It's important to take the time to get to understand the customer's organization on an intimate level in order to propose the best product solution possible. Below are the tasks and assets you'll need to facilitate successful discovery call meetings.

1. Prepare a meeting agenda to identify how the buyer wants will match what you will cover. This can be sent ahead to the buyer to ensure alignment. For each agenda item, include some questions from the BPM, prepare statements, industry case studies. Research 1-3 items in the Objectives and Obstacles section of the personas. Finalize your meeting objectives in order to

show the buyer you are prepared, listening, and empathic. Structure the meeting so that the prospect is relaxed and is comfortable going deep with their problems and needs.

1. Use the Customer Requirements Document during the meeting to capture the feedback from your discovery questioning.

1. Use the Command Plan to track the progress of a deal. It's an iterative document within Salesforce that gives you and your team macro and micro level visibility into an opportunity. It is designed to align and guide you through the necessary MEDDPIC process to quickly capture the information necessary to properly qualify an opportunity. Here is a sample Command Plan.

1. Create a customer deck. The customer deck should be specific to the opportunity and utilize the customer's branding when possible. Additionally, the customer deck should be created with input from a primary point of contact or an identified champion.

1.2 Creating the customer deck (Phase 1)

The goal of developing and presenting a good pitch is to obtain a verbal commit from the customer. Again, traditional sales representatives tend to overwhelm customers with a long overview of the company and its product features in the hopes that one of the features will resonate with the customer and create a sense of urgency to buy.

Always avoid making a pitch more about us than the customer. At GitLab the approach is more consultative. This is the reason that insight into the customer based on individual research and discovery calls is so important. It gives you an intimate understanding of what the customer's problems are and their long term goals. Your responsibility in developing and presenting a GitLab sales pitch is to align the customer's problem to a particular GitLab product based solution. You have worked with the customer to this point to do the heavy lifting and understand what they need. Now as a consultant you are presenting a solid solution to meet their immediate needs but also providing a solution roadmap of their long term goals and needs.

As a rule, a GitLab Sales Pitch deck should be no more than 10-15 slides. You can use the GitLab Customer Template and reduce it to the recommended number of slides.

For Enterprise Strategic Account Leaders, you can also use this GitLab ENT SAE Proposal Template to give you a headstart on a custom proposal for your customer.

It is also recommended that the presentation be more visual rather than text heavy. A GitLab customer deck should contain the following components:

1. Value Drivers

1. How GitLab can Help

1.2.1 Align customer problems with value drivers

As a GitLab sales representative you should know from your discovery calls and research your customer's pain points well enough to match them to one if not all of the GitLab Value Drivers. GitLab has the following three value drivers:

- Increase Operational Efficiencies
- Deliver Better Products Faster
- Reduce Security and Compliance Risk

Your job is to call out the specific key pain points and show the customer how their pain aligns with GitLab's value drivers.

1.2.2 Show how GitLab can help

The next component of the pitch deck is showing how GitLab can help. This will require you to understand the customer's specific use case. Your discovery calls should have provided much of the data to define the problem, but going further you must do the following:

- Research Customer Use Cases
- Align the customer's pain point to a typical customer use case
- Explain what GitLab does in relation to the associated customer use case

This part of the customer deck will help orient your customer to what GitLab is and how we can help them.

1.2.3 AE/SAE transition to Solution Architect

The data gathered from the discovery calls is analyzed by AE/SAE to make the determination of whether to qualify the lead in terms of GitLab value to their organization. Upon determination of qualifying, the AE/SAE then should engage a Solution Architect to begin the transition to the scoping phase of the sales process.

1. AE/ SAE performs a Gap Analysis of data captured from discovery questioning and is held in the Customer Requirements document. Align customer requirements on the spreadsheet to the specific GitLab product line and denote if GitLab does or does not meet the requirement. This analysis will also provide you with possible DevOps cycle entry points as customer requirements and goals do vary.

1. AE/SAE introduces and engages the Solution Architect in technical conversations and reviews Customer Requirement Document with Solution Architect.

1. AE/SAE updates relevant SFDC fields with new information for formal handoff to the Solution Architect for Scoping. Utilize the Command Plan to track the progress of a deal. It's an iterative document within Salesforce that gives you and your team macro and micro level visibility into an opportunity.

Step 2: Scoping

Scoping represents an opportunity to discuss customer requirements in more detail. This step is the primary responsibility of a Solution Architect (SA). The SA will do a deep-dive technical requirements review based on the documents provided by the AE/SAE. The SAs main goal in scoping is to understand all the necessary elements that need to be brought into the project scope and identify the pieces that need to be brought together in order to produce a successful outcome for all stakeholders. The tasks necessary to accomplish proper scoping are the following:

1. Review the Customer Requirements document and any associated meeting notes to identify gaps and create more indepth discovery questions related to technical capabilities.

1. Perform high-level technical discovery calls with the customer and work together to review the Customer Requirements Document and gather more context and insight into the customer's requirements.

1. Analyze the updated requirements against GitLab products to determine a fit assessment. If a

fit is determined, initiate a Technical Evaluation.

1. Identify Opportunities to Sell Professional Services. The SAE/ISR can find the general services the PS team offers on the services page or for more details specific SKU offerings, on the full catalog. The SAE/ISR can pull the SA in for help selecting services needed based on customer requirements.

Step 3: Technical Evaluation

Technical evaluation is where the prospective customer evaluates the fit of GitLab to their organization and their specific business outcomes. This may be driven by a Lite POV, a free trial, real time or asynchronous Q&A, a workshop and/or other approach requiring technical guidance from an SA. If Discovery did not include the SA, the AE should follow the triage process to engage an SA for the opportunity, filling out the issue template and providing MEDDPIC information as well as the known required capabilities in Salesforce. The following are tasks the SA must review and manage during technical evaluation.

1. Update Customer Requirements documents and review Google Docs and Salesforce for running meeting notes with customer environment and technical specifications.
1. Setup a free trial of GitLab based on the following Technical Evaluation Criteria.
1. Create a solution design blueprint from requirements gathering, tech discovery, and customer meta-records.
1. Create a Proof of Value when necessary which focuses on specific customer business outcomes that cannot be achieved through other technical and/or business interactions.
1. Submit a Proof of Value (PoV/PoC) plan to stakeholders for approval.

Hold a strategy meeting: Once the SA has completed the solution design blueprint and/or the Proof of Value, the sales representative will need to hold a strategy meeting with the SA to discuss the highpoints of the solution in order to prepare and present a pitch deck to the customer. If the sales representative does not have deep technical product depth, it will be even more important to debrief the solution blueprint with the SA.

Command of the Message is defined as "being audible ready to define solutions to customers' problems in a way that differentiates you from your competitors & allows you to charge a premium for your products & services." This means you must in many ways understand the customers pain points and goals better than they do and speak to real solutions. The solution is presented to the customer through a pitch deck.

At this point, it may also be beneficial to engage the Risk and Field Security Team to provide security assurance support. Prior to making a financial commit, many customers will require security due diligence. The AE, SAE or SA may utilize the Customer Assurance Package for self-service resources or request assistance through the Customer Assurance Activities Procedure.

3.1 When to present the GitLab Demonstration

Should you include the demonstration within the same meeting as the sales pitch? Typically 50% of the time the demonstration is presented in the same meeting with the pitch deck being delivered first.

However, this is an audible-ready moment where the AE/SAE and SA need to meet as a team and discuss if the customer is ready for the demonstration. This should be an agenda item at the

regular account management meetings and each team needs to set the criteria of whether to combine a pitch deck meeting with a demonstration on a customer by customer basis. The demonstration should be tailored to the customers specific pain points and business goals. Again, traditional sales representatives tend to overwhelm customers with a long overview of the company and its product features in the hopes that one of the features will resonate with the customer and create a sense of urgency to buy.

- (SAE/AE) Conduct 30-day Trial POV. During this trial the sales representative and technical buyer should have established metrics for success. These metrics will help measure how involved GitLab will be in the trial. The sales representative should have weekly touch points to see how GitLab is performing against Metrics within the POV trial.
- (SAE/AE) Perform Paper Process Discovery during the end trial POV. Obtain information on who needs to sign off from the technical buyer. Document the paper process and determine the economic buyer(s) and work to get access to the economic buyer through the technical champion. The goal is to integrate the economic buyer into the process at this point.

3.1.1 Getting the Technical Commit

A Technical Commit takes place within the Technical Evaluation POV through a series of working sessions where GitLab capabilities are mapped to business and technical requirements within the Customer Requirements Document. When the technical champion has socialized within the organization that GitLab's capabilities meet or exceed their technical needs in dealing with their business drivers and want to move forward, this is a verbal Technical Commit.

3.1.2 Finding your champions

A Champion is the person within your client's organization that will sell on your behalf when you're not there. They will guide you through the decision making process, introduce you to key players and decision makers, and alert you when things go wrong. For medium to high engagement deals, try to obtain a minimum both a technical champion and a business champion. The technical champion can guide you through the Technical Evaluation steps and hopefully help get the Technical Commit. The business champion if they are not one in the same as the technical champion will provide you with insight into the paper process, decision makers, and internal organizations that have influence on whether the opportunity moves forward or not. The criteria for a champion are as follows:

- Someone that has influence and be at least Manager/Director level or above
- Demonstrate that they have sway on the decision making process
- Can remove barriers to the deal
- Will put their value currency on the line to push the initiative

If the person does not meet the above criteria, they should be deemed an advocate. An advocate speaks well on your behalf, socializes your solutions, and helps you understand the landscape within the organization. However, they cannot remove barriers to a deal.

As you facilitate the deal, you must constantly test your points of contact as possible champions or advocates. For this reason, it is best to have multiple advocates and multiple champions to create a point of contact safety net for changing positions and changing initiatives.

Step 4: Getting the commit from the Economic Buyer

To get an economic commitment you have to help a customer organization understand their common pain points and goals and assist them to plan to address those pain points and goals without being overtly involved in the decision making process. It creates urgency by showing the customer that the pain associated with not partnering with GitLab is greater than any pain associated with moving forward (3 Whys: Why GitLab, Why Now, Why Do Anything At All).

When you can do this properly, you will have made a consultative based case that compels the customer to make a decision to buy. This is done on the same side of the table with your identified champions/advocates. Below are the steps that need to be taken to engage and get a commitment from an economic buyer.

4.1 Update the Customer Deck (Phase 2)

To engage the economic buyer you need a customer focused deck that aligns high level business needs with GitLabs Value Drivers. The customer deck should be created with the idea that your champion can present it to the economic buyer. To do this you will need to work side-by-side with your advocates and champions to update the customer deck you created earlier to provide the following components to an economic buyer:

1. Case Study that aligns with the customer
1. Justification
1. Preliminary Pricing Proposal
1. Ask for the Commit/Next Steps

4.1.1 Align Customer Problems with Value Drivers

Align the customer needs to an existing GitLab case study. To locate a good case study go to Customer Reference Documents. You'll need to build a few slides that distill the main points of the case study to align it to the customer you are pitching.

4.1.2 Business Justification

A justification is defined as the action of showing something to be right or reasonable. You'll need to work with your champion to clearly show the business justification for choosing GitLab by creating a graphic representation of one or all of the following points:

1. Highlight the efficiencies you'll get versus your current toolset
1. Return on Investment
1. Metrics of how much more productive you'll be with GitLab versus the next best alternative

4.1.3 Preliminary Pricing Proposal

Preliminary pricing is usually based on the Proof of Value designed by the Solution Architect. Work with your champion(s) to further align preliminary pricing with the justification and ROI that you should have already created in the customer deck.

Additionally, test your champion during the late stage of the Technical Evaluation process to get an idea of the pricing and budget implications that may present themselves and incorporate

that information into the preliminary pricing proposal.

4.1.4 Ask for the Business & Next Steps

1. Set next steps and dates with the customer to move into the Deal Closure phase. Engage with the champions and economic buyer to create a mutually agreed upon action plan to deployment. This is called a Mutual Close Plan and should be documented in the Command Plan.

1. Update the opportunity stage and status in Salesforce from Proposal to Negotiating
1. Update Clari with the latest forecasting projections based on your most recent sales motions.

At this point the opportunity now moves the Deal Closure phase, phase three of the GitLab sales cycle.

SECTION: sales/sales-operating-procedures/retain-and-expand.md

Once the account is won it is time for the AE/SAE/CSM/PSE to work together to ensure Customer Success. This requires Account Engagement by all parties. The components of this are:

- Customer Onboarding
- Customer Implementation
- Customer Account Management
- Customer Account Expansion

In the retention and expansion phase, the roles and responsibilities of th